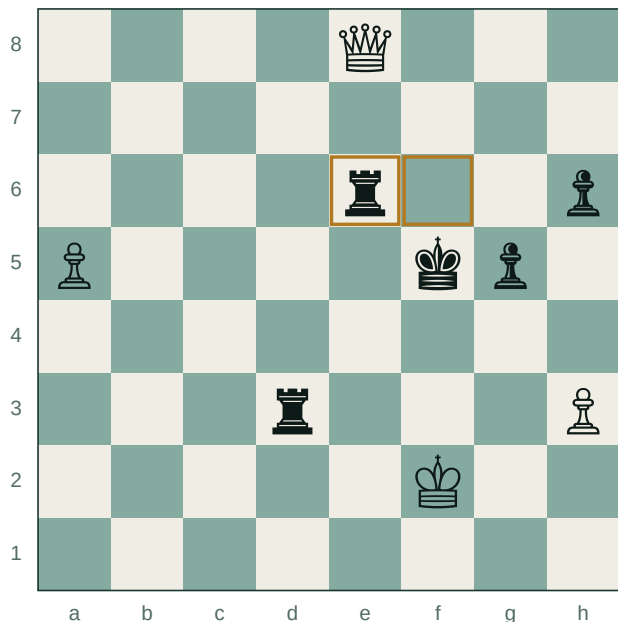


Queen-and-rook endings: White, move 45

Queen-and-rook endings

White to move



Previous move: 44...Re6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

45. Qb5+ Ke4 46. Qc4+ Rd4 47. Qxe6+

45.Qb5+ Check restricts Black to 6 legal replies here. From b5 it attacks king on f5 and rook on d3. Recorded reply: **45...Ke4**.

46.Qc4+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From c4 it attacks king on e4, rook on e6 and rook on d3. Recorded reply: **46...Rd4**.

47.Qxe6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on e6.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 7 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -1 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on f5. Geometrically undefended: rook on d3. Check for tactical protection.